

1851

GOLD STRUCK IN AUSTRALIA

Edward Hargraves, a veteran of the California gold rush, discovered flecks of gold in a waterhole near Bathurst, New South Wales, in February 1851. Larger nuggets were soon discovered in Victoria, and a huge influx of gold diggers from Britain, America, Germany, Poland, and China arrived in Australia, quadrupling the population in just 20 years.



△ Panning for gold



1814-64
HONG XIUQUAN

A religious leader and revolutionary, Hong challenged China's Qing dynasty, establishing the Taiping Heavenly Kingdom, and declaring himself both "Heavenly King" and Jesus Christ's younger brother.

1854 London-based physician John Snow discovers that cholera is a waterborne disease; this finding transforms public sanitation

1854

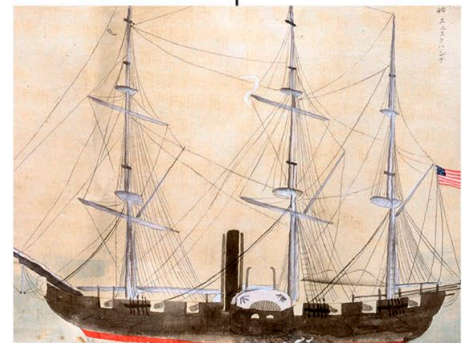
1854 CRIMEAN WAR BEGINS

After Russia occupied Turkish territory in 1853, France and Britain, determined to preserve the Ottoman Empire as a bulwark against Russian expansion, invaded the Crimea and besieged the Russian naval base at Sevastopol in 1854. Both sides were hampered by incompetent leadership and fought in terrible conditions. Sevastopol was captured in 1855 and Russia surrendered its claims to Ottoman lands in 1856.

▷ **British veteran** of the Crimean War



▽ A Perry expedition ship, Japanese painting



1854 JAPAN ENDS POLICY OF SECLUSION

In 1853-54, Commodore Matthew Perry led a fleet of US warships into Tokyo Bay to force Japan to open itself to foreign trade after 200 years of seclusion under the Tokugawa Shogunate. This act of gunboat diplomacy revealed to Japan that it was ill-equipped to defend itself against the modern weapons and ships of the industrialized West.